

CARO

It stands for Computer Antivirus Research Organisation, which is an informal group of professional antivirus researchers committed to improving the state of the art.

Cavity Infector, Cavity Virus

A cavity virus overwrites a part of its host file without increasing the length of the file while also preserving the host's functionality.

Class Infector

A class infector is a macro virus whose code resides in one or more class modules.

Cluster Virus, Link virus

Apart from directly infecting host files as appenders and prependers do, there are other ways to intercept calls to an executable file and run malicious code, either before or instead of, the code from the intended file. One such method is cluster infection, used by a small number of DOS viruses.

CMOS

Complementary Metal Oxide Semiconductor: The battery backed RAM used in AT and later PCs to store hardware configuration information uses CMOS technology. As this memory is not in the CPU address space, but addressed via I/O port reads and writes, its contents cannot be directly executed. This means that viruses cannot reside in nor infect the CMOS RAM. Some viruses alter the contents of the CMOS RAM as a payload, either scrambling them or removing the reference to the floppy drive so the hard drive's (infected) MBR will always run first during boot-up.

Commercial RAT

Any commercial product that is normally used for remote administration, but which might be exploited to do this without a user's consent or awareness is called a Commercial RAT. Also see RAT.